

The River Answers Back: The Decision

河流的回应：决定

Theme: 环境、自然与可持续发展 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6, 127

English Story

The decision came **between** two things the group could not have both of: a **metal** lock on the canal and a forest that keeps its own **timber**. “**Someone** has to choose,” the **activist** said, “and the **achievement** will be small either way.” **Rarely** had the station been so close to a real question.

The **agriculture** office wanted a **restaurant**, a **cellar** of **dairy** and **beef**, and a chain of **snack** stalls selling **goose sausage**. “A **darling** of a plan,” the chairperson said, “but the **forestry** figures are not **persuasive**, and the **rainy** season is **pressing**.”

The decision was to **dine indoors** and to keep the **utmost** care for the west floor. A **cinema**, a **zoo**, and a **robotic** milking shed were all deferred; the **climatic** data and the **misty** mornings mattered more than the **dessert**. “**Seldom** has a project been so unglamorous,” Maya wrote, “and **seldom** so necessary.”

The **pressing** question was where the money would come from, and the answer was an **achievement** of a different kind: a **maid**, a carpenter, and a violinist each donated one day a month. A **fable** about a **victorious goose** and a **marvelous eraser** was printed for the school.

The difficult part was to **finalize** a plan that reduced the add-on work, cut the center of the old scheme, and dealt with the either-or of **agriculture** and **forestry**. The term began with a full floor of volunteers and less money than the summer.

Within the decision there was a smaller one: to begin with the west bank, to attempt the readings before the deal was signed, and to keep the top of the file blank until the reading arrived. “We are **between** two rivers now,” the boatman said. “That is the only place worth standing.” The difficulty of the decision was either small or total: the floor of the **cellar**, the west room, and the center of the town all needed less, and the term would begin with a full set of reduced plans. The scene at the **restaurant** was less dramatic than the **fable**, and more useful. A summer of readings had reduced the argument to one page. A **chopstick**, a plate of **meat**, and an **idiomatic** phrase borrowed from the **zoology** department: **doubtless** the smaller **accomplishment** was to add nothing to the menu.

中文翻译

决定落在两样二者不可兼得的东西之间：运河上的一把金属水闸，以及一片保留自己木材的森林。“总得有人选，”活动人士说，“而无论选哪边，成就都很小。”这个站很少如此靠近一个真正的问题。

农业部门想要一家餐馆、一个装满乳品和牛肉的地窖，以及一连串卖鹅肉香肠的小吃摊。“方案很可爱，”主席说，“但林业的数字不具说服力，而雨季正逼近。”

决定是在室内用餐，并对西侧地面保持最大的谨慎。一家电影院、一座动物园和一座机器人挤奶棚都被推迟；气候数据和雾蒙蒙的早晨比餐后甜点更重要。“很少有项目如此不风光，”曼雅写道，“也很少如此必要。”

紧迫的问题是钱从哪里来，而答案是另一种成就：一位女仆、一位木匠和一位小提琴手每月各捐出一天。为学校印了一则关于一只胜利的鹅和一块了不起的橡皮的寓言。

困难的部分是要定稿一份削减附加工作、砍掉旧方案中心，并处理农业与林业之间二选一的计划。这个学期以一个满员的志愿者楼层和比夏天更少的钱开始。

在这个决定之内还有一个更小的决定：从西岸开始，在签署协议之前先尝试那些读数，并让文件顶部保持空白，直到读数到来。“我们现在处在两条河之间，”船夫说，“那是唯一值得站立的地方。”这个决定的困难要么很小，要么是全部：地窖的地面、西边的房间，以及镇中心，都需要更少，而这个学期将以一整套缩减后的方案开始。餐馆里的那一幕没有寓言那么戏剧化，却更有用。一个夏天的读数把这个论证压缩成了一页纸。一根筷子、一盘肉，以及一个从动物学系借来的惯用语：毫无疑问，那个更小的成就是没有给菜单上加任何东西。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
between bi'twi:n POS: prep	prep. 在...之间 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in the interval; r. in between
thing θɪŋ POS: n	n. 事物, 东西, 物, 用品, 事, 事件, 情况, 行为, 特征 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a special situation; n. an action; n. a special abstraction; n. an artifact
within wɪ'dɪn POS: n	n. 内部, 里头; adv. 在内部, 在内心里; prep. 在...之内 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r on the inside
someone 'sʌmwʌn POS: pron	pron. 有人, 某人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a human being
restaurant 'restərɒŋ POS: n	n. 餐馆, 饭店 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a building where people go to eat
metal 'metəl POS: n	n. 金属, 金属制品, 合金, 本质, 质料; a. 金属制的; vt. 以金属覆盖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cover with metal
meat mi:t POS: n	n. 肉, 餐, 食物; [经] 肉类 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the flesh of animals (including fishes and birds and snails) used as food
achievement ə'tʃi:vmənt POS: n	n. 完成, 成就, 功业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the action of accomplishing something
rarely 'reəli POS: adv	adv. 很少地, 罕有地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. not often
agriculture 'ægrɪkʌltʃə POS: n	n. 农业; [机] 农业, 农学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the class of people engaged in growing food
activist 'æktɪvɪst POS: n	n. 激进主义分子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. advocating or engaged in activism
timber 'tɪmbə POS: n	n. 木材, 木料; vt. 用木材建造 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a beam made of wood; n. a post made of wood
darling 'dɑ:lɪŋ POS: n	n. 亲爱的, 可爱的人, 可爱的物; a. 可爱的, 亲爱的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a special loved one; n. an Australian river; tributary of the Murray River
cinema 'sɪnəmə POS: n	n. 电影院, 电影 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a theater where films are shown
beef bi:f POS: n	n. 牛肉, 肌肉; vt. 养(牛), 宰(牛); vi. 抱怨, 告发 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. cattle that are reared for their meat; n. meat from an adult domestic bovine
dessert di'zɜ:t POS: n	n. 餐后甜点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a dish served as the last course of a meal
accomplishment ə'kʌmplɪʃmənt POS: n	n. 成就, 完成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the action of accomplishing something
seldom 'seldəm POS: a	a. 不常的, 稀少的; adv. 很少, 不常 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r not often
maid meɪd POS: n	n. 少女, 未婚女子, 女仆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a female domestic; n. an unmarried girl (especially a virgin)
snack snæk POS: n	n. 小吃, 点心, 快餐; vi. 吃零食, 吃快餐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a light informal meal; v eat a snack; eat lightly
goose gu:s POS: n	n. 鹅, 雌鹅, 鹅肉, 弯把熨斗; vt. 与...性交, 突然加大油门, 使生色, 喝倒彩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. web-footed long-necked typically gregarious migratory aquatic birds usually larger and less aquatic than d...
dairy 'deəri POS: n	n. 牛奶公司, 乳品店, 乳牛场 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a farm where dairy products are produced
sausage 'spsɪdʒ POS: n	n. 香肠, 腊肠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. highly seasoned minced meat stuffed in casings
forestry 'fɒrɪstri POS: n	n. 林学, 森林地; [法] 林地, 林学, 林业 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the science of planting and caring for forests and the management of growing timber
doubtless 'daʊtlɪs POS: a	a. 无疑的, 确定的; adv. 无疑地, 确定地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r without doubt; certainly

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
cellar 'sele POS: n	n. 地窖, 地下室, 藏酒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. storage space where wines are stored
zoo zu: POS: n	n. 动物园 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the facility where wild animals are housed for exhibition
pressing 'presɪŋ POS: a	a. 紧迫的, 迫切的, 热切的; n. 压, 压榨, 冲压件, 唱片 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a metal or plastic part that is made by a mechanical press; s. compelling immediate action
marvelous 'mɑ:veləs POS: a	a. 令人惊异的, 了不起的, 不平常的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. being or having the character of a miracle
dine daɪn POS: vi	vi. 用正餐, 进餐; vt. 宴请 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have supper; eat dinner; v. give dinner to; host for dinner
rainy 'reɪni POS: a	a. 下雨的, 多雨的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s (of weather) wet by periods of rain
indoors 'ɪn'dɔ:z POS: adv	adv. 在户内 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r within a building
persuasive pə'sweɪsɪv POS: a	a. 有说服力的, 劝诱的, 劝导性的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. intended or having the power to induce action or belief
utmost 'ʌtməʊst POS: n	n. 极限, 最大限度, 极度; a. 极度的, 最远的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the greatest possible degree
robotic rəʊ'bɒtɪk POS: a	a. 自动的; 机器人的, 像机器人的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to mechanical robots
climatic klaɪ'mætɪk POS: a	a. 气候的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to a climate
misty 'mɪstɪ POS: a	a. 有雾的, 模糊的, 笼罩着雾的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. wet with mist
victorious vɪk'tɔ:riəs POS: a	a. 胜利的, 得胜的, 战胜的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having won
fable 'feɪbl POS: n	n. 寓言, 神话, 谎言; vi. 虚构, 作寓言 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a short moral story (often with animal characters)
finalize 'faɪnəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使结束, 定稿; vi. 定局 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make final; put the last touches on; put into final form
eraser 'ɪreɪsə POS: n	n. 擦子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an implement used to erase something
zoology zəʊ'blɒdʒɪ POS: n	n. 动物学, 动物区系; [医] 动物学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the branch of biology that studies animals
idiomatic 'ɪdɪə'mætɪk POS: a	a. 符合语言习惯的, 惯用的, 有许多习语的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to or conforming to idiom
chopstick 'tʃɒpstɪk POS: n	n. 筷子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of a pair of slender sticks used as oriental tableware to eat food with